SAP DATA & ANALYTICS PRODUCT MARKETING

CHAPTER ONE

The Old Playbook Is Dead

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futureofpmm.com/curriculum

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Core Thesis: The agentic era didn't accelerate the old B2B playbook—it ended it. Product lifecycles now run in continuous deployment, not quarterly releases. Buyers consume content through AI intermediaries, not your website. GEO has replaced SEO. The funnel is no longer a funnel.

And the PMM who survives this transition is not the one who learned to prompt faster—it's the one who understood what changed and why.

The Story of Sarah

Sometime in late 2024, a product marketer we know—let's call her Sarah—noticed something strange in her pipeline data. Sarah ran product marketing for a mid-market analytics platform, the kind of company that sells to data teams at Fortune 2000 firms. She was good at her job. She'd built the positioning, trained the sales team, published the battlecards, ran the launches. Her funnel metrics had been steady for two years.

And then, over the course of about six weeks, three things happened simultaneously.

First, her website traffic went up—but her form fills went down. More people were visiting the product pages, but fewer were downloading the white papers and requesting demos. Second, her sales team started reporting that prospects were showing up to discovery calls already knowing things they shouldn't have known—competitive pricing, technical limitations, integration details that lived in documentation Sarah's team hadn't even promoted. Third, and most unsettling, two enterprise deals closed in under three weeks. That had never happened before. The typical sales cycle for Sarah's product was eleven weeks.

Sarah's first instinct was that something was broken in the analytics. Maybe a tracking pixel had died. Maybe the CRM had hiccupped. But the data was clean. What had actually changed was something far more interesting: her buyers had started using AI agents to do the research, the comparison shopping, and the vendor pre-qualification that used to take human buying committees weeks of meetings, spreadsheets, and hallway conversations to accomplish.

The agents weren't doing anything magical. They were reading her product documentation—all of it, including the stuff buried three clicks deep that no human prospect ever found. They were pulling her pricing from G2 and Gartner Peer Insights and running it against competitors. They were synthesizing analyst reports and customer reviews into concise briefs for their human principals. They were, in effect, doing the job of a procurement analyst, a technical evaluator, and a competitive intelligence researcher all at once, and they were doing it in hours instead of weeks.

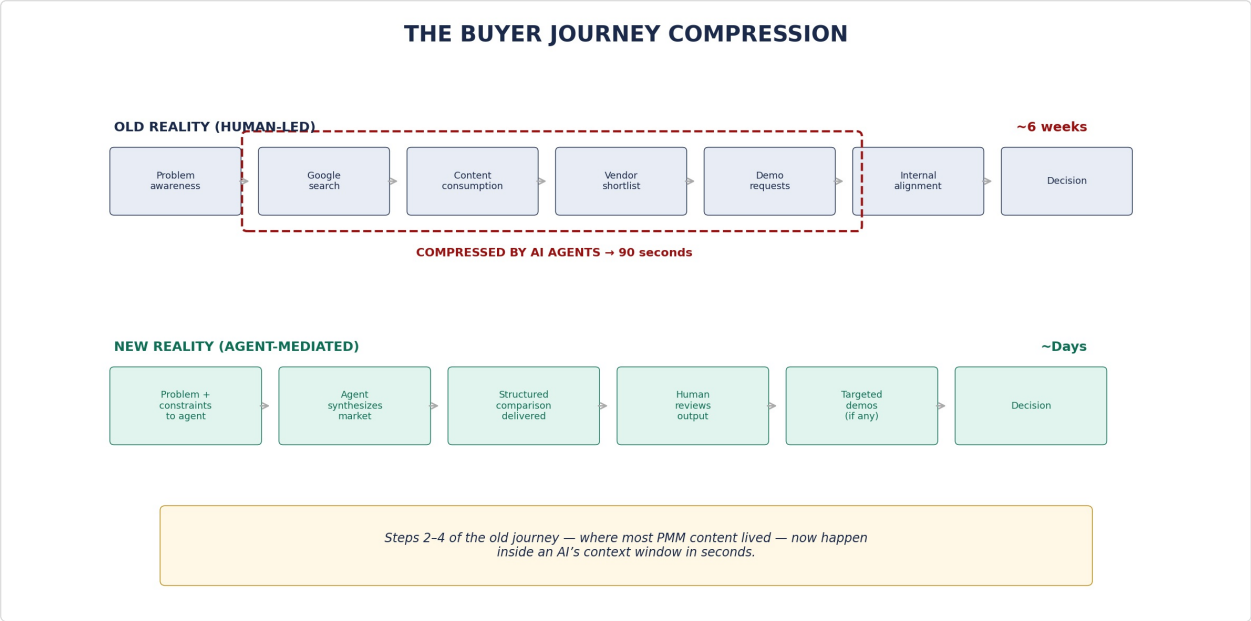


Figure 1: The old buyer journey vs. the new agent-mediated journey. Steps 2–4—where most PMM content lived—now happen inside an AI's context window in seconds.

Sarah's content hadn't changed. Her positioning hadn't changed. Her product hadn't changed. But her buyer had fundamentally changed—or rather, her buyer had hired an intermediary that didn't care about brand affinity, didn't respond to emotional storytelling, and couldn't be schmoozed over a steak dinner. And that intermediary was making decisions—or at least dramatically shaping the decisions—that determined whether Sarah's product made it to the shortlist.

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This chapter is about what happens next. Not in the abstract, feel-good, "AI will augment human creativity" sense. Concretely. If you're a product marketer—whether you carry the title of PMM, Director of Product Marketing, or VP of Go-to-Market—you already feel the ground shifting. You've probably been told that AI will "supercharge" your workflow. You've been handed a ChatGPT license and told to figure it out. Maybe your company has an "AI task force" that meets biweekly and produces PowerPoint decks about the art of the possible.

None of that is what this curriculum is about.

> This curriculum is about the structural transformation of product marketing as a discipline. Not "how to use AI tools"—though we'll cover the tools, because you need to know what's actually good and what's vaporware. The real story is that the economics, the workflows, and the buyer dynamics that have defined product marketing for the last twenty years are all changing at once.

The Three Eras of Enterprise Data

There is a company in Stuttgart—we can't name them, but you'd recognize the logo—that has been running SAP for thirty-one years. Their SAP Business Warehouse holds over two decades of transactional history: every purchase order, every invoice, every production run, every quality inspection, every customer interaction, organized into cubes and InfoProviders that a generation of consultants built and a generation of analysts learned to query.

When we sat down with their CIO in late 2024, she said something that has stayed with us ever since: "We have more data than any

company in our industry. And we have less insight than a startup with a Snowflake account and two data engineers."

That sentence captures the paradox that has defined enterprise data management for the last decade. The history of how companies collect, organize, and activate data is not just a technology story—it's the story of what becomes possible when the architecture changes. Every time the data foundation shifts, the go-to-market motion shifts with it. The companies that recognize the shift early build advantages that compound for years. The ones that wait get commoditized.

We think of this history in three eras, defined not by the marketing tools that sat on top but by the data architecture that sat underneath everything.

Era One: The Data Warehouse and the Age of Reports

For most of the 1990s and 2000s, the center of gravity for enterprise data was the data warehouse. SAP BW, Teradata, Oracle—these were the systems of record for analytics, and they operated on a simple premise: extract data from your operational systems, transform it into a structured model, and load it into a warehouse where analysts could run reports. ETL—extract, transform, load—was not just a technical process; it was a philosophy. You moved the data to the analytics. You waited for the batch job to run overnight. And in the morning, you had your numbers.

For product marketers, this era defined the job in ways that persist to this day. The PMM's deliverables were fundamentally static: positioning documents, messaging frameworks, campaign briefs, competitive battlecards that were accurate on the day they were written and started decaying the moment they were saved. The Pragmatic Institute built its framework during this era, and the framework reflects the cadence of warehouse-era data—quarterly reviews, annual planning cycles, periodic competitive updates. The data moved slowly, so the marketing moved slowly, and that was fine because the buyers moved slowly too.

Era Two: The Data Lake and the Age of Unification

The second era arrived not as a single product launch but as a slow-motion crisis of fragmentation. Enterprises woke up one morning—metaphorically, though some of them describe it exactly that way—and realized their data was everywhere. The warehouse still existed, but now there was also a data lake on AWS. A Snowflake instance that the analytics team had spun up. A Databricks workspace for the data science team. Half a dozen SaaS applications, each with its own data model and its own API.

This was the era that produced the customer data platform—the CDP—which Chris and Martin Kihn wrote the book on (literally: Customer Data Platforms, Wiley, 2021). The CDP was an attempt to solve the unification problem for marketing: take all the customer data from all the systems, resolve the identities, and create a single customer view. The tagline that emerged from that work captured the generational shift: "A DMP knew your audience. A CDP knows your customer."

For product marketers, the unification era expanded the job dramatically. The PMM was no longer just writing positioning and campaign briefs. Now the job included lifecycle marketing, personalization strategy, customer journey mapping, win/loss analysis, and a whole set of activities that required understanding individual customers and their relationship with the product.

Era Three: The Data Fabric and the Age of Agents

Which brings us to now. And the line that captures this era:

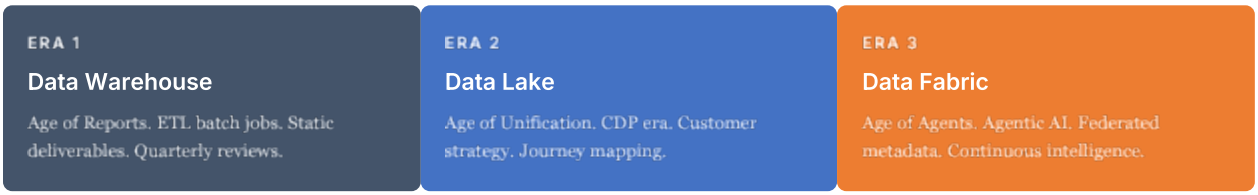
> **THE EVOLUTION**
>
> A DMP knew your audience. A CDP knew your customer. An AMP knows your business. And now the buyer has an agent too.

In February 2025, we launched SAP Business Data Cloud—a fully managed SaaS platform that unified SAP Datasphere, SAP Analytics Cloud, and SAP Business Warehouse with an embedded Databricks partnership, all built around a shared object store and zero-copy data exchange. The product strategy behind BDC was something we had been building toward for years: stop asking customers to move their data to the analytics, and instead bring the intelligence to the data.

When we say agentic, we mean something specific: software systems that can perceive their environment, make decisions, and take actions without waiting for a human to tell them what to do at each step. Not chatbots. Not copilots that suggest the next sentence in your email. Agents that monitor your competitive landscape while you sleep. Agents that adjust your pricing recommendations based on real-time market signals. Agents that generate and test messaging variants based on what's resonating with different buyer

segments.

For product marketers, this changes the game. The earlier shifts asked PMMs to expand their skill set. The fabric-to-agent shift asks PMMs to redefine their role entirely—from executors who produce artifacts to strategists who direct agents that produce artifacts at a pace and quality that no individual human could match.



The Visibility Gap

Let us return to Priya, the VP of IT at a mid-market manufacturing company. In 2023, Priya's evaluation of enterprise data platforms would have touched thirteen distinct pieces of vendor-produced content across six weeks: Google searches, vendor websites, analyst reports, a webinar, peer conversations, and a conference.

In 2026, Priya opens her AI research assistant and types: "Compare the top enterprise data platforms for manufacturing supply chain analytics. Include integration capabilities with SAP ERP, pricing models, and implementation timelines for companies our size." The assistant returns a structured comparison in about ninety seconds.

It pulls from technical documentation, third-party review sites, analyst databases, and structured product data. It does not pull from the beautifully designed PDF case study that one vendor spent forty thousand dollars producing. It does not pull from the video testimonial that another vendor filmed at their customer conference. It does not open the email nurture sequence that a third vendor has been sending Priya for a month. Those assets are invisible—not because they're bad, but because they're formatted for human consumption in channels that agents do not access.

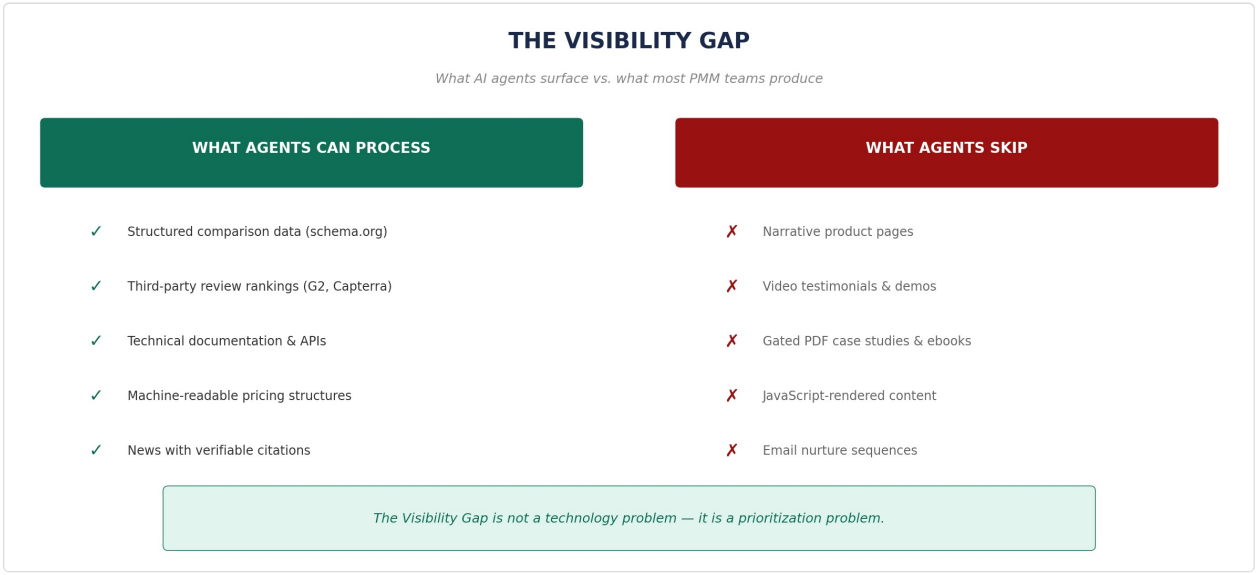


Figure 2: The Visibility Gap—what AI agents can process vs. what they skip entirely.

THE CORE INSIGHT

The Visibility Gap is not a technology problem—it is a prioritization problem. The assets agents surface are already within the PMM's scope. They just haven't been treated as strategic outputs.

From SEO to GEO

For twenty years, SEO has been the organizing discipline of digital marketing. Entire careers have been built on understanding how Google's algorithms rank content, how to structure pages for crawlability, how to build backlink authority. SEO is not dying—traditional search still generates traffic and will for years—but it is being joined, and in some B2B contexts overtaken, by something we call Generative Engine Optimization, or GEO.

The difference between SEO and GEO is not cosmetic. SEO optimizes for ranking—appearing high on a list of blue links. GEO optimizes for citation—being included in a synthesized answer that an AI generates. In SEO, you compete for keywords. In GEO, you compete for entity authority—the degree to which AI models associate your brand with specific capabilities, use cases, and categories. In SEO, you build backlinks. In GEO, you build structured proof points that AI systems can verify and cite. In SEO, content volume helps. In GEO, content structure helps.

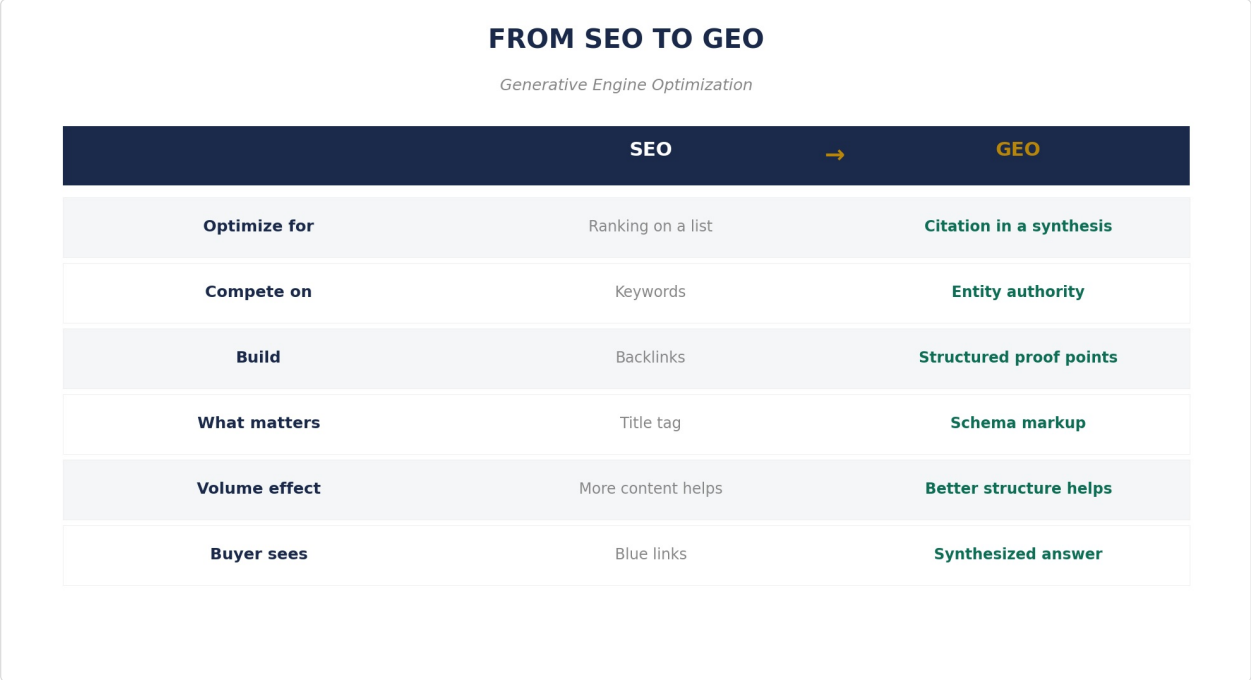


Figure 3: The shift from SEO to GEO—from ranking to citation, from keywords to entity authority.

THE AUDIT (DO THIS WEEK)

Open Claude, ChatGPT, or Perplexity, and ask it to evaluate vendors in your product category for a common use case. See if your company appears. Read what it says about you. Compare it to what your competitors' entries look like. That sixty-second exercise will tell you more about your GEO readiness than any consultant's report.

The Pragmatic Framework Meets the Machine

If you've been through Pragmatic Institute training—and there's a decent chance you have, since they've certified over 250,000 professionals—you know the Framework. Thirty-seven boxes arranged in seven categories: Market, Focus, Business, Planning, Programs, Enablement, and Support. Each box represents an activity that a product team needs to execute well to bring a product to market successfully. It's been the closest thing the product management and product marketing disciplines have to a shared operating system for three decades.

We've stared at that framework a lot over the past year. Not because we were studying for a certification—we were trying to answer a

question that we couldn't find anyone else asking in a rigorous way: what happens to each of those thirty-seven boxes when AI agents become part of the team?

The exercise produced three natural clusters that organize the rest of this curriculum.

Cluster One: Automated

These are activities where AI agents can perform the majority of the work today, with human oversight reduced to quality checks and strategic direction. Take Market Sizing. The traditional approach: a PMM spends two to three weeks pulling data from Gartner, IDC, Statista, company filings, and industry reports, builds a bottom-up model in Excel, triangulates against a top-down estimate, and produces a slide deck. An agent with access to the right data sources can do this in an afternoon. Not approximately. Actually well.

Or take derivative Content Creation—once you have a core messaging framework and a strong point of view, the mechanical act of turning that into blog posts, social copy, email sequences, and slide decks is straightforward generation work. The first-draft quality was good enough that the human's job became editing and elevation rather than creation from scratch. That's a 70% time savings on the production side, conservatively.

Here's the uncomfortable truth about Cluster One: these are the activities that many PMMs spend the majority of their time on. If you're a PMM whose primary value is producing artifacts—the battlecard, the one-pager, the launch email sequence, the competitive slide—the automation wave is not your friend. The question isn't whether this happens. It's whether you're the person directing the agents or the person being replaced by them.

Cluster Two: Augmented

These are activities where the human remains essential but the human-agent team is so much better than the human alone that operating without agents becomes a competitive disadvantage. Positioning is the canonical example. No agent is going to write your positioning from scratch—not because the technology can't generate positioning statements (it can, all day long) but because positioning is fundamentally a strategic choice about what you want to be known for, who you're willing to lose, and how you want to show up relative to alternatives. Those are judgment calls. But an agent can synthesize the inputs that inform those judgment calls—win/loss data, competitive positioning shifts, analyst commentary, customer verbatims—at a speed and comprehensiveness that no human can match.

Win/Loss Analysis falls squarely here. The traditional process covers twenty deals in a quarter. An agent-augmented PMM can process hundreds of deal records, pull themes from call transcripts, cross-reference against CRM data, and surface patterns that would take a human months to identify. The human still needs to interpret those patterns and decide which ones are actionable. But the input quality is transformatively better.

Cluster Three: Elevated

This is where it gets interesting—and where the career implications are most significant. These are the activities that become more important, more central, and more career-defining in the agentic era precisely because they are the ones that machines can't do.

Stakeholder Management—every PMM knows that the hardest part of the job isn't writing the positioning document; it's getting twelve people to agree on it. No agent is going to sit in that room and read the body language and know that the reason the VP of Sales is pushing back isn't because they disagree with the positioning but because they're worried about quota attainment. That's organizational intelligence. It's learned, not computed.

Customer Empathy is the one that surprises people, but it shouldn't. An agent can analyze ten thousand support tickets and tell you that 23% mention onboarding friction. A human can sit across from a customer, watch their face, and understand that the real problem isn't the onboarding UX—it's that the customer doesn't have executive sponsorship and they're trying to drive adoption bottom-up in a top-down culture. That's a completely different product marketing challenge, and no amount of ticket analysis will surface it.



Market sizing, derivative content, event logistics, sales tools production.

If your value is producing artifacts, the automation wave is not your friend.

Positioning, win/loss analysis, buyer personas, pricing strategy.

Operating without agents becomes a competitive disadvantage.

Stakeholder management, customer empathy, thought leadership.

These become MORE important because machines can't do them.

The Curriculum Architecture

This curriculum is organized around a remapping of all thirty-seven Pragmatic activities to the modern B2B funnel—from Awareness through Advocacy. Each subsequent chapter takes a stage of the funnel and anchors it to the specific Pragmatic boxes that drive it, reframed for the agentic era.

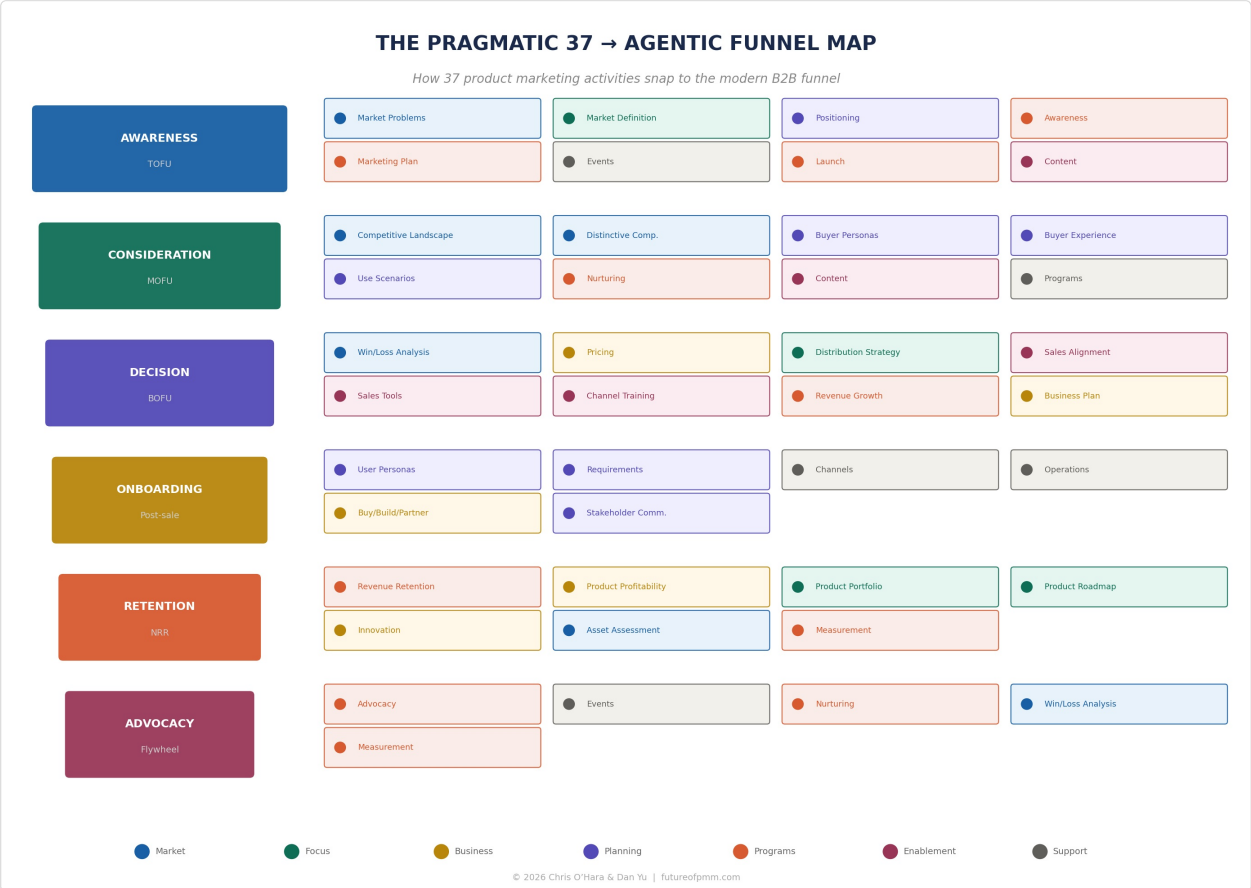


Figure 4: The Pragmatic 37 → Agentic Funnel Map. All 37 activities mapped to the six-stage agentic funnel, color-coded by Pragmatic category.

THE 10X THESIS

A PMM who automates twenty hours a week of Cluster One work and redirects that time into deeper competitive analysis, more thoughtful positioning, better stakeholder management, and genuine thought leadership is going to outperform a PMM who's still manually updating battlecards. Not by twenty percent. By a factor that justifies the title of this book.

That's not a threat. It's an opportunity—arguably the biggest opportunity in the history of the PMM discipline. Product marketing has always suffered from being spread too thin. The Pragmatic Framework has thirty-seven activities because the job really does encompass all of that. No single person can do all thirty-seven well. The agentic era doesn't shrink the list—it makes it possible, for the first time, for an individual PMM to meaningfully cover the full scope while going deep on the activities that matter most.

That is what "10x yourself" means. Not working ten times harder or ten times faster. Operating at a fundamentally different level of strategic impact because you've offloaded the mechanical work to machines that are built for it, and you're finally free to do the work that only a human can do.

THE CMO PERSPECTIVE

The conversation about AI inside marketing departments right now is almost entirely wrong. It's focused on efficiency—how do we produce the same outputs with fewer people, or the same people in less time. That's a CFO question, not a CMO question.

The CMO question—the one we wrote this curriculum to answer—is how do we produce fundamentally different outputs? How do we shift from quarterly competitive reviews to continuous intelligence? How do we move from static messaging frameworks to dynamic positioning that adapts to what agents are surfacing in real time?

What we've seen firsthand, running a product marketing organization of forty-plus people at SAP, is that the PMMs who are thriving aren't the ones who adopted AI tools first. They're the ones who rethought their workflows first and then found the tools that matched.

Key Takeaways

- The agentic shift is a structural transformation of the PMM discipline, not just a toolkit upgrade.
- Buyer behavior has already changed—AI agents are compressing research cycles from weeks to hours, and most PMM content is invisible to them.
- The "10x" thesis isn't about speed. It's about the widening output gap between PMMs who internalize the shift and those who don't.
- The Pragmatic Framework's 37 activities cluster into three tiers: automatable, augmentable, and irreducibly human.
- The PMM who frees Cluster One hours to invest in Cluster Three is operating at a different level.
- This curriculum maps all 37 activities to the agentic funnel—each subsequent chapter covers a stage with its anchored Pragmatic boxes, reframed for the era we are in.